Arhan Harchandani

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EDUCATION

Dubai College, UAE *2020 - 2027*

- **A-Levels:** Economics, Physics, Mathematics, Extended Project Qualification
- **GCSE Subjects:** Economics, Physics, Spanish, Mathematics, Computer Science, Biology, English Literature, English Language, Design Technology, Chemistry
- **SAT:** 1520 (780 Math, 740 English)

Johns Hopkins University Pre-College Summer Program *July 2025*

- Selected for a two-week course in Big Data & Social Media. Explored behavioral patterns, ethics, and data-driven civic engagement.

AWARDS & HONORS

- Winner, Tether, The Junior Academy Challenge (New York Academy of Sciences), 1st of 221 teams **(2026)**
- Won CREST Gold by the British Science Association for research **(2026)**
- 1st Runner-Up & Best Innovation Award, macOS Voice Assistant, Dubai Science Fair (70 projects) **(2026)**
- Achieved Gold in Senior UK Maths Trust (UKMT) **(2025)**
- Achieved Gold in Intermediate UK Maths Trust (UKMT) **(2025)**
- Best Prototype Award, Automated Sustainable Desk Assistant in Dubai Science Fair, among 55 students **(2025)**
- Duke of Edinburgh Bronze Award **(2024)**
- Represented Dubai College in Gulf Debates & British Schools in the Middle East (BSME) **(2023)**

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

Founder, **Rewoven** *Aug 2024 - Present*

- Founded a sustainability initiative addressing textile waste and promoting circular fashion awareness among youth.
- Launched the Rewoven mobile app & website, featuring interactive sustainability quizzes, games, educational articles, a sustainable fashion explorer, clothing impact scanner, upcycle marketplace, and donation tracking tools.
- Reached an audience of 500+ individuals through Rewoven. Donated and diverted 1000+ items of clothing from landfill via Beit Al Khair Society, saving an estimated 2.3 million litres of water.
- Led product design, branding, and marketing for a student-run sustainable fashion initiative using repurposed garment waste, generating USD 8000+ in proceeds donated to charity.
- Rewoven has been featured in Emirates 24|7 for our work using AI to tackle Gen Z's fast-fashion waste.
- Partnered with Fashion Revolution UAE and presented Rewoven during Fashion Revolution Week.
- Organized a session on Rewoven for the sustainability society at Dubai College.

Founder, **Trade Buddy** *Oct 2024 - Present*

- Initiative promoting sustainable consumption by enabling families to exchange and reuse school-related items, reducing household waste and unnecessary purchases.
- Developed a community platform for parents to trade textbooks, uniforms, and equipment within school networks.
- Preparing school-wide rollout through institutional communication channels to increase participation and item reuse.

Research Author, **From Concern to Choice: Climate Change and Sustainable Clothing Adoption - Market Study for Rewoven** *April - Sept 2026*

- Designed and deployed a cross-sectional survey in the UAE to assess consumer demand, sustainability awareness, donation behavior, and barriers to adopting Rewoven's circular-fashion platform.
- Identified a 17.2% knowledge-behavior gap among high-sustainability knowledge users, highlighting awareness-to-action barriers in sustainable clothing disposal.
- Found that 66.7% of non-donors were willing to donate when practical barriers were removed, supporting convenience-focused features such as donation locators and clothing-label scanners.
- Published in Curieux Academic Review (October 2026, Issue 12), page 443. Won CREST Gold Award from the British Science Association.

LEADERSHIP INITIATIVES

Co-Founder & CTO, **Avlynor** *Feb 2026 - Present*

- Co-founded Avlynor to take Tether forward following its 1st-place win at the Junior Academy Challenge. Tether is a clinical companion app for post-discharge patients, with a research programme investigating whether voice changes can give an earlier signal of deterioration.
- Led end-to-end product development: built a cross-platform app for patients, clinicians, and caregivers; engineered a Cloudflare Workers backend with secure authentication and role-based access; and developed a research-stage voice-analysis engine.
- Working towards a first pilot of Tether in hospital discharge wards in Sweden, with a roadmap to scale internationally.
- Venture Cup 2026 regional finalist: one of 10 startups selected in Region Syd (southern Sweden), from 264 entries nationwide.

Founder, **Big Data and Social Media Society, Dubai College** *Jan 2026 - March 2026*

- Founded a student-led society at Dubai College exploring the impact of big data, algorithms, and social media on society.
- Conducted 8 interactive sessions for 11 students focusing on consumer behaviour, digital influence, and the application of data-driven insights to encourage more sustainable choices.

Organizer, **Basketball Community Initiative, Manila, Philippines** *Dec 2025; August 2026*

- Organized and led basketball training sessions for 30 underprivileged youth in Manila, promoting physical well-being, teamwork, and confidence.
- Organized a pilot clothing redistribution initiative in Manila, donating sports jerseys to underserved youth through a community basketball program supporting 50+ beneficiaries.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Sustainability Analyst, **Embee International Industries, Egypt** *July 2024, 2025 & 2026*

- Conducted sustainability audits of textile production processes, assessing fabric sourcing, energy and water consumption, waste generation, and management practices.
- Analyzed textile waste streams by source and material; explored opportunities for reuse, recycling, and material recovery across production processes.
- Developed resource-efficiency and circularity recommendations to reduce textile waste and improve material recovery; presented findings to management.
- Insights informed the development of the Rewoven initiative. Connected industrial textile-waste challenges with the need for more garment reuse and redistribution.

Intern, **Hello Chef, Dubai** *August - Sept 2026*

- Suggested initial ideas to reduce food waste in operations; identified opportunities for simple process improvements.
- Documented the end-to-end monthly payroll process for 60+ employees. Built a prototype tool to generate and validate the UAE Wage Protection System (WPS) bank file directly from the payroll sheet, replacing a manual export-and-edit process.
- Developed a four-stage automation proposal covering payroll, HR-system integration, and expense approvals, based on a structure developed with the CFO.

Business Development and Corporate Intern, **Hamdan Al Shamsi Law Firm** *August 2025*

- Drafted Terms & Conditions and Privacy Policy for a client mobile application, ensuring compliance with UAE data protection standards.
- Assisted the Business Development team with research into family offices and preparing materials for clients.
- Prepared client materials and gained exposure to corporate operations within a UAE law firm.

Intern, **Supermax Enterprise Trading Corporation, Philippines** *August 2024*

- Developed understanding of decentralized energy solutions and sustainability challenges in emerging markets.
- Assisted in the installation of a fully operational off-grid solar energy system, supporting renewable power deployment.

Intern, **Urban Intelligence Lab, Dar** *Oct 2024 - March 2025*

- Completed a six-month internship program on Artificial Intelligence in Urban Development at Dar's Urban Intelligence Lab, a Research Affiliate of MIT.

EXTRA-CURRICULARS

Organizer, **Sustainability Society** *Aug 2026 - Present*

- Organized a session on Rewoven; presented to 50+ students on textile waste and circular fashion, and led an interactive quiz.
- Recruited student ambassadors to raise awareness of Rewoven and encourage peers to engage with sustainable fashion.

Founder, **Digital Preservation Project** *Feb 2025 - Present*

- Established a digital archiving service converting legacy photographs and media into high-quality digital formats.
- Preserved 5,000+ photos and videos for 20+ clients.

Basketball *2022 - Present*

- Won Philippine Basketball Association U18 Youth League; Most Valuable Player (MVP) - BBA U16 Youth League (2024).
- Won 2nd place at Dubai Affiliated School Sports Association (DASSA) U16 League.
- Represented Dubai College across U14, U16, and U19 teams; 4+ years of competitive training and league play.

Sailing *2022 - Present*

- Trained for 3 hours a week & certified sailor at Dubai Offshore Sailing Club; selected for youth racing squad.

TEDxDubai College *2026*

- Selected to deliver a TEDx talk on Big Data & Social Media at TEDxDubai College.

Hiking & Expeditions *March - April 2024*

- Completed Everest Base Camp expedition, raising 50,000 AED to support the refurbishment of a special-needs school.
- Additional high-altitude expeditions: Mount Meru, Mount Washington and Mount Rainier.

SKILLS

- Programming (JavaScript, TypeScript, Rust, Java, Swift, Go, Elixir)
- Data Analysis (Excel, SQL)
- AI Tools & Automation
- App Prototyping & UI/UX
- Embedded Systems (Arduino/Raspberry Pi)
- Research & Report Writing
- Advanced Sailing